

Irregular verbs

Spelling change

## How to Conjugate Irregular Spanish Verbs

Once you master verb conjugation in Spanish for regular verbs, you'll need to memorize a few rules for the irregular ones. There are three primary categories to learn regarding irregular Spanish verb conjugation, which include spelling changes, stem changes, and a few special Spanish verbs that don't really follow a pattern.

### Spelling Changes

Some Spanish verbs undergo a complete change of spelling when they're conjugated in certain tenses. This is common for verbs ending in -uir, -cer, and -cir.

When conjugating Spanish verbs that end in -uir, the i will change to a y in all forms except from nosotros/nosotras and vosotros/vosotras. For example, when conjugating incluir (to include) it becomes yo incluyo, tú incluyes, Usted incluye, and so on and so forth.

When conjugating Spanish verbs that end in -cer or -cir, the change depends on what comes before the ending. When there's a consonant before the -cer or -cir, the c will change to a z, and the rest of the verb is conjugated normally. However, this only occurs in first person (yo). For example, vencer (to defeat) conjugates to yo venzo. If there is a vowel before the -cer or -cir, the c will remain, but you'll add an extra z before it. For example, producir (to produce) becomes yo produzco. Remember, these are only on the first-person conjugation. All of the rest undergo normal Spanish verb conjugation.

A few more examples of verbs that have a spelling change when conjugated in first-person (yo) form include the following:

- Conocer (to know) – yo conozco
- Hacer (to do, make) – yo hago
- Traer (to bring) – yo traigo
- Salir (to leave) – yo salgo
- Saber (to know) – yo sé

This isn't the entire list of irregular Spanish verbs that require a spelling change. Unfortunately, there's no way to remember these irregular verbs aside from practice and memorization, so try to use them often to help them stick.